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GUIDELINE FOR PREPARATION OF A SITE MASTER FILE (SMF) FOR WHOLESALERS OF MEDICAL DEVICES

This document serves as a guideline to assist applicants to comply with the requirements for a Site Master File (SMF) regarding the wholesaling of medical devices (including In vitro diagnostics (IVDs)). The South African Health Products Regulatory Authority (SAHPRA) is committed to ensure that all premises where medical devices are procured and stored for the purposes of selling to retailers and end users are of the required quality, safety and performance, and that wholesaling activities are conducted comply with statutory requirements and complies with acceptable quality assurance principles and good wholesale practices as determined by the Authority.

Document History

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Contents

Document History.....	1
Glossary	4
1. INTRODUCTION	5
1.1 Purpose	5
1.2 Scope	5
2. LEGAL PROVISION.....	5
3. REQUIREMENTS OF A SITE MASTER FILE.....	5
3.1 General	5
3.1.1 Brief information on the site, any information relevant to understanding the wholesaling operations..	6
3.1.2 Name, physical address of the site and contact details.....	6
3.1.3 List of medical devices (including IVDs) procured and stored on site, and information about the handling, storage conditions and transportation of medical devices on site (mentioning any special precautions taken for storage, e.g., dedicated facility, fridge items, etc.)	6
3.1.4 Use of third-party service providers in relation to wholesaling activities, if applicable	7
3.1.5 Description of the Quality Management System (QMS) of the wholesaling facility and activities	7
3.2 . PERSONNEL	7
3.2.1 Organisational chart showing the arrangements for key personnel	7
3.2.2 Qualifications, experience, and responsibilities of key personnel.....	8
3.2.3 Outline of arrangements for basic and in-service training and how records are maintained.....	8
3.2.4 Health and safety management requirements for personnel engaged in wholesaling	8
3.3 PREMISES AND EQUIPMENT	9
3.3.1 Site plan or description of wholesaling areas (size, location and immediate environment and other wholesaling activities on the site), with indication of scale (architectural or engineering drawings are not required).....	9
3.3.2 Brief description of ventilation systems (More detail should be given for critical areas providing special storage conditions).....	9
3.3.3 Special areas for the handling of highly toxic, hazardous, fridge-line and radio-active medical devices (including IVDs).....	10
3.3.4 Site maintenance (description of planned preventive maintenance programmes and recording system)	10
3.3.5 Availability of written specifications and procedures for cleaning wholesaling areas and equipment ..	10
3.3.6 Policy on the storage of medical devices (including IVDs).....	11
3.4 STOCK HANDLING AND STOCK CONTROL	11
3.4.1 Arrangements and recording system for wholesaling	11

3.4.2 Deliveries and transportation	12
3.5 DOCUMENTATION.....	12
3.5.1 Arrangements for the preparation, revision, storage, and distribution of necessary documentation for wholesaling activities. Any other documentation related to product quality which is not mentioned elsewhere.	12
3.6 MEDICAL DEVICE COMPLAINTS AND FIELD SAFETY CORRECTIVE ACTIONS	13
3.6.1 System for the handling of complaints of medical devices.....	13
3.6.2 Arrangements for handling of field safety corrective actions.....	13
3.7 INTERNAL AUDITS.....	14
3.7.1 Short description of the internal audit system	14
4. REFERENCES	14
5. VALIDITY	14
ANNEXURE A.....	15
Categories of medical devices handled at this site	15

Glossary

Abbreviation/ Term	Meaning
GWP	Good Warehouse Practice/ Good Wholesaling Practice - Means a scope of compliance requirements for the control of wholesaler operations of a medical device.
IVD	In-Vitro Diagnostic medical device
FIFO	First-In, First-Out - Means a system where the first medical device received is the first to be dispatched.
QA	Quality Assurance - Means the responsibility and activity of ensuring that the warehouse facility and wholesaling systems meet GWP.
QMS	Quality Management System - Means collective policies, plans, practices, and the supporting infrastructure by which an organization aims to reduce and eventually eliminate non-conformances to specifications, standards, and customer expectations in the most cost effective and efficient manner.
RUO	Research Use Only
SMF	For the purpose of this document, a Site Master File is a document prepared by the medical device and IVD wholesaler and should contain specific information about the quality management policies and activities of the site, the quality control of wholesaling activities carried out at the named site and any closely integrated operations at adjacent and nearby buildings.
Wholesaler	Means a dealer who purchases a medical device from a licensed manufacturer or distributor and sells to a retailer or end user in terms of Section 22H of the Medicines and Related Substances Act, 101 of 1965.

1. INTRODUCTION

The Site Master File (SMF) is a mandatory supporting document for a medical device establishment license application in accordance with section 22C of the Medicines and Related Substances Act (Act 101 of 1965).

The Site Master File (SMF) is prepared by the wholesaler, and it contains specific information about the quality assurance and/or quality control of medical device wholesaling operations performed at the site and any closely integrated operations as adjacent and nearby buildings. A Quality Manual (QM) which is applicable to Manufacturers and Distributors (Importers) is also sufficient when submitting a medical device establishment licence application for wholesalers.

1.1 Purpose

This document guides medical device wholesaler applicants on preparation of a SMF.

1.2 Scope

This guideline is applicable for the preparation of a SMF that is used for application of medical device establishment license for wholesaler.

This guideline is not applicable for the QM document required for application of medical device including IVDs establishment license for manufacturers and/or distributors (importers).

2. LEGAL PROVISION

- a) Medicines and Related Substances Act, 101 of 1965, as amended
- b) Regulations relating to medical devices (including IVDs)
- c) Hazardous Substances Act, 15 of 1973, as amended

3. REQUIREMENTS OF A SITE MASTER FILE

3.1 General

The SMF must have an issue number and an effective date, and must be updated when a major amendment or upgrade is made within the operations or when key activities and/or key personnel change.

An updated SMF must be submitted for the renewal application of a medical device establishment licence every five years or for any amendment application thereof. Wherever possible, digitized plans or schematic layouts should be included instead of a narrative.

3.1.1 Brief information on the site, any information relevant to understanding the wholesaling operations.

GUIDANCE

- a) *Outline the company's wholesaling activities.*

3.1.2 Name, physical address of the site and contact details

GUIDANCE

- a) *Name of company*
- b) *Physical address of the site*
- c) *Telephone number for office hours*
- d) *E-mail address of contact person*

3.1.3 List of medical devices (including IVDs) procured and stored on site, and information about the handling, storage conditions and transportation of medical devices on site (mentioning any special precautions taken for storage, e.g., dedicated facility, fridge items, etc.)

GUIDANCE

- a) *List the product Risk Classification and Type of medical devices (including IVDs) procured, handled, or stored on site. See Annexure A.*
- b) *List any toxic, hazardous, highly sensitising substances and radio-active medical devices, e.g., biological reagent and radioactive material*
- c) *Indicate special precautions taken for such medical devices.*

3.1.4 Use of third-party service providers in relation to wholesaling activities, if applicable

GUIDANCE

For each third-party service provider, provide the following information:

- a) Physical address of the company*
- b) Telephone number*
- c) E-mail address*
- d) Brief outline of the activities being undertaken*

3.1.5 Description of the Quality Management System (QMS) of the wholesaling facility and activities

GUIDANCE

- a) State the wholesaler's Quality Policy.*
- b) List the processes of the Quality Assurance (QA) system, e.g., organizational structure, responsibilities, procedures.*
- c) Describe the audit programs (self-inspection or audits by external organizations undertaken).*

3.2 . PERSONNEL

3.2.1 Organisational chart showing the arrangements for key personnel

GUIDANCE

- a) Organogram listing key personnel responsible for wholesaling activities.*

3.2.2 Qualifications, experience, and responsibilities of key personnel

GUIDANCE

- a) Brief details of academic qualifications, work-related experience, and years of relevant experience since qualifying.*
- b) Provide a brief job description for key personnel.*

3.2.3 Outline of arrangements for basic and in-service training and how records are maintained

GUIDANCE

- a) Describe how training needs are identified and by whom.*
- b) Provide details of training related to GWP requirements.*
- c) State the form of training, e.g., in-house, external, and how practical experience is gained, and which staff are involved.*
- d) Explain how the effectiveness of the training is assessed, e.g., by questionnaires.*
- e) Explain how retraining needs are identified.*
- f) Give brief details of the type of training records kept.*

3.2.4 Health and safety management requirements for personnel engaged in wholesaling

GUIDANCE

- a) Give brief details, e.g., name, designation, qualification, contact number of personnel responsible for ensuring the safety of employees.*

3.3 PREMISES AND EQUIPMENT

3.3.1 Site plan or description of wholesaling areas (size, location and immediate environment and other wholesaling activities on the site), with indication of scale (architectural or engineering drawings are not required)

GUIDANCE

- a) Provide a site plan indicating the location of the site and surrounding area as well as highlighting all wholesaling and other functional areas.*
- b) Include a description of the site, the location and immediate environment and the size of the site and types of building*
- c) Give a brief description of the controls available to prevent unauthorized access.*
- d) Provide a floor plan of each area with an indication of scale. Label areas and annotate the plan with names.*

3.3.2 Brief description of ventilation systems (More detail should be given for critical areas providing special storage conditions)

GUIDANCE

Provide a brief description of ventilation systems with more detail for critical storage areas (provide schematic drawings).

Include the following data:

- a) Specification of air supply*
- b) Temperature*
- c) Humidity*

3.3.3 Special areas for the handling of highly toxic, hazardous, fridge-line and radio-active medical devices (including IVDs)

GUIDANCE

- a) *Provide the same layout as above in Section 3.3.1 for the description of areas specifically designated for the handling of highly toxic, hazardous, fridge-line and radioactive medical devices.*

3.3.4 Site maintenance (description of planned preventive maintenance programmes and recording system)

GUIDANCE

- a) *Describe the preventative maintenance programme.*
- b) *Mention the person responsible for the maintenance and servicing of equipment.*
- c) *Provide written procedures and contractual details for third-party service providers.*
- d) *Provide written procedures and suitable reporting forms for maintenance and servicing of wholesaling equipment.*
- e) *Mention the documentation process involved in recording the type and frequency of services and checks, including the details of service, repairs and modifications to wholesaling equipment.*
- f) *Describe and identify maintenance routines that could possibly affect the medical device including IVDs quality.*

3.3.5 Availability of written specifications and procedures for cleaning wholesaling areas and equipment

GUIDANCE

- a) *Provide cleaning procedures for each area.*
- b) *Provide cleaning methods and frequencies used for delivery vehicles.*

3.3.6 Policy on the storage of medical devices (including IVDs)

GUIDANCE

- a) *Describe how medical devices (including IVDs) are segregated and controlled, e.g., by computer, labels, etc.*
- b) *Describe how medical devices are stored, e.g., pallet racking.*
- c) *Describe any special storage or handling conditions.*
- d) *Describe pest control management.*

3.4 STOCK HANDLING AND STOCK CONTROL

3.4.1 Arrangements and recording system for wholesaling

GUIDANCE

- a) *Description of receiving, handling and storage of medical devices:*
- b) *Inspection of medical devices (including IVDs) at point of receipt.*
- c) *Describe how batch/lot numbers and expiry dates are managed during the receipt and dispatch of stock. Additionally, describe the inventory management system method followed to ensure proper stock rotation.*
- d) *Describe the methods of distribution used to customers, e.g., post, courier, van services, customer collection, etc.*
- e) *Records of distribution: Describe how the retained records permit full batch traceability from the Original Equipment Manufacturer to the customer, in terms of the date of sale, customer details, and quantity dispatched.*
- f) *Describe stock-take procedures, including information on the manner and frequency in which inventory control is conducted.*

3.4.2 Deliveries and transportation

GUIDANCE

- a) *Description of how the security, storage conditions and protection of the quality of medical devices (including IVDs) are maintained during transportation.*
- b) *Description of the vehicle fleet available:*
- c) *Number of vehicles and their capacity*
- d) *Details of the vehicle specially adapted to transport special medical devices (e.g., cold items, radioactive medical devices) when applicable.*
- e) *How the transport route is planned (e.g., cold items, radioactive medical devices).*

3.5 DOCUMENTATION

3.5.1 Arrangements for the preparation, revision, storage, and distribution of necessary documentation for wholesaling activities. Any other documentation related to product quality which is not mentioned elsewhere.

GUIDANCE

Arrangements for the preparation, revision and distribution of documentation:

- a) *Provide a description of the documentation system.*
- b) *State the personnel responsible for the preparation, revision, and distribution of documentation.*
- c) *Specify where the master documents will be stored.*
- d) *State the standard format and instructions on how documents are to be prepared.*
- e) *Describe how documentation is controlled.*
- f) *State the period for keeping the documents (e.g. five years etc).*
- g) *Detail any arrangements for electronic records.*

3.6 MEDICAL DEVICE COMPLAINTS AND FIELD SAFETY CORRECTIVE ACTIONS

3.6.1 System for the handling of complaints of medical devices

GUIDANCE

- a) *Describe the procedure for medical device complaints.*
- b) *State the personnel responsible for logging, classifying, and investigating complaints.*
- c) *State if written reports of complaints will be prepared and the personnel responsible for reviewing the reports.*
- d) *State the period for keeping the records of complaints (e.g. five years etc)*

3.6.2 Arrangements for handling of field safety corrective actions

GUIDANCE

- a) *State the written procedures that are in place in the following processes:*
- b) *Retrieval of distribution data.*
- c) *Notification of customers.*
- d) *Receipt/segregation/inspection of returned medical devices.*
- e) *Investigation and reporting of complaints and adverse events.*
- f) *Reporting corrective action.*
- g) *State the personnel responsible for coordinating field safety corrective actions.*
- h) *State who should notify the Authority of field safety corrective action.*

3.7 INTERNAL AUDITS

3.7.1 Short description of the internal audit system

GUIDANCE

- a) *Describe how the internal audit system verifies that those activities that have a bearing on medical device quality comply with the planned arrangement.*
- b) *State documented procedures that are in place for self-inspection and any applicable follow-up actions.*
- c) *State whether the results of the internal audit will be documented and brought to the attention of the personnel responsible for the areas and activities that are being inspected.*
- d) *State whether corrective actions will be taken to address deficiencies found in the audit in a timely manner.*

4. REFERENCES

The following related documents are referenced:

- a) Singapore Health Science Authority, GN-03: Guidance and Preparation of a Site Master File for Licensing
- b) Medicines and Related Substance Act, 101 of 1965, as amended
- c) Regulations relating to Medical Devices and In Vitro Diagnostic Medical Devices (IVDs)
- d) World Health Organization, WHO Technical Report Series, No.961, 2011
- e) GLF-MD-06B Licence Application Medical Device Wholesaler Form
- f) SAHPGL-MD-05 Guideline on Medical Device Quality Manual

5. VALIDITY

This guideline document is valid for a period of five (5) years from the effective date of publication. It will be reviewed in line with this timeframe or as and when required.

ANNEXURE A

Categories of medical devices handled at this site

Please indicate by ticking the appropriate box/boxes with an X:

Type of Medical Device:		Class of Medical Device				
		A	B	C	D	RUO
Sterile						
Measuring Medical Device						
Blood storage / transportation product						
Non-Invasive						
Invasive Medical Device	< 60 min					
	> 60 min & < 30 days					
	> 30 days					
Inactive Medical Device						
Active Medical Device						
Contraceptive						
Combination Medical Device						
IVD						